

SHIPYARDS ON COAST TO RECEIVE CONTRACTS

WASHINGTON, July 2.—All doubt as to the future activities of the Portland and other Coast shipyards was decided when Congress passed the civil sundry bill and provided enough money for the minimum ship program of the shipping board. Reinstatement of cancelled contracts on the Coast will speedily be made and the Coast will build a good share of the hundreds of millions of dollars worth of 12,000 to 15,000-ton ships authorized in the bill just passed.

Contracts for these and some of the ships to be reinstated will be announced next week.

Portland will get a good share and no possible cause for non-employment or lack of activity in the shipyards for many months to come can be laid at the door of congress or the shipping board.

COMMISSION A S K S ADMINISTRATION TO DELAY ROUTING PAPER

SALEM, June 30.—The United States railroad administration has been asked by the state public service commission to delay its proposed re-routing of paper and paper products from Oregon City and Camas, Wash., until after a hearing on various phases of the situation can be held. The railroad administration has proposed to eliminate all water routing, substituting railroad routings from these two points. In a letter to F. W. Robinson, chairman of the Portland district freight traffic committee, Commissioner Williams stated that a number of protests have been lodged with the commission against this action. Shippers generally, Williams declares, are opposed to the elimination of the water routing, which has been in force for so long that any change at this time without a full hearing is not justified. It is expected the Washington state commission will enter a similar protest against the proposed elimination of the water routing.

FEDERAL FARM LOAN ASSOCIATION OF THE NORTHWEST FORMED

SALEM, June 30.—The largest federal farm loan association in the entire Northwest, and probably the largest association of its kind in the United States, was formed by the merging, last week, of the Horticultural Farm Loan association and the Hoskins National Farm Loan association under the name of the Oregon National Farm Loan association with headquarters in Salem. The organization, which covers Marion, Polk, Benton, Lincoln, Clackamas, Yamhill, and Linn counties, is capitalized at \$50,000. Loan applications already closed in the two old organizations and new loans pending in the present organization total \$700,000. A. C. Bohrmstedt, who has been secretary-treasurer and general manager for the two associations up to the time of the merger, will continue in that same capacity under the reorganization. Other officers of the association are E. B. Hull, Hoskins, president; John U. Plak, Macleay, first vice-president; Martin L. Franz, Hoskins, second vice-president; directors, A. H. Litchfield, Salem; C. A. Poole, Salem; Andrew C. Carson, Salem; L. D. Fry, Hoskins; Frank L. Price, Hoskins; A. O. Hathaway, Corvallis; A. F. Beardsley, Salem.

Labor Envoys Demanding Peace

SOUTHPORT, England, June 27.—British, French and Italian labor representatives have decided to make a general demonstration July 20 or 21 to protest against allied intervention in Russia. This announcement was made by Arthur Henderson, British labor leader, at the labor conference here today.

The conference later adopted a resolution calling upon the Trade Union congress to take industrial action in order to compel the British government to stop operations in Russia.

Progressive Counties

"This is the most liberal voting Clackamas County ever did in its history and arouses hope that some day it will join the procession of progressive counties," remarks the Oregon Voter in referring to the vote of this county in the special election June 3 last. The Voter says that one-third of the registered voters went to the polls, or more than an average for the state, which would indicate to our mind that the Clackamas voters were interested to a greater extent in the measures presented than the people of other counties, in the average.

As a matter of fact Clackamas County was not far wrong in its judgment on the several measures and amendments submitted. Without an educational campaign this county cast 42 per cent of its voting strength at the election in favor of the 6 per cent road bond limit. The Roosevelt military coast highway measure obtained nearly an even break and the market roads bill received a majority.

This county did not approve the reconstruction measures, the principal reason being that the people felt the legislature deserved a rebuke for submitting a proposition involving the expenditure of \$5,000,000 as a blanket proposal, rather than giving the people the right to pass upon each of the numerous appropriations on their merits.

The word "Progressive" is merely a term. This county has been one of the foremost in its indorsement of progressive legislation, and because its people refuse to approve every money-spending bill proposed is no reason why it should be stigmatized as non-progressive.

PEACE PACT IS SIGNED BY GERMANS SATURDAY

VERSAILLES, France, June 28.—The peace treaty was signed this afternoon in the historic Hall of Mirrors by the German peace delegation and their conquerors, formally ending the world's greatest war—a four-year struggle between the Teutonic autocracies and 27 other nations.

The credentials of Dr. Hermann Mueller and Dr. Johannes Bell, German plenipotentiaries sent here to sign the treaty of peace, were approved this morning.

The peace treaty was deposited on the table in the Hall of Mirrors at 2:10 o'clock this afternoon by William Martin, of the French foreign office. It was enclosed in a stamped leather case.

Premier Clemenceau entered the palace at 2:20 o'clock.

A few minutes before 3 o'clock the 15 enlisted men from the American, British and French armies entered the hall amid decorous cheers.

President Wilson entered the Hall of Mirrors at 2:50 o'clock. All the delegates then were seated except the Chinese, who did not attend. The Chinese reiterated their intention not to sign.

The Germans entered the hall at exactly 3 o'clock.

Premier Clemenceau called the session to order at 3:10 o'clock.

Premier Clemenceau put the direct question to the Germans whether they were willing to sign and execute loyally all the terms. The other delegates did not arise when the Germans came into the hall.

The treaty was signed by Dr. Hermann Mueller at 3:12 and Dr. Johannes Bell at 3:13 p. m. The American delegation signed in this order: Secretary Lansing, Henry White, Colonel House and General Bliss.

Guernsey Breeders Picnic on Saturday

The Charles Wagner farm near Wilsonville was the scene of a happy gathering of Guernsey breeders Saturday who met for an all day picnic. A large number of registered Guernsey cows, heifers and bulls were exhibited. The meeting was presided over by Octave Voigt of Hubbard. Professor E. B. "Fits of Corvallis" spoke on the "Value of Good Breeding," illustrating his talk by pointing out the good points of some of the animals on exhibition. N. C. Jamison, county agent of Washington county, spoke on the "Value of Testing for Advanced Registry." Mrs. A. I. Hughes told of some of the opportunities for selling both grade and registered Guernseys. Judge Goodin, a Washington county breeder, told of his experiences as a breeder. R. G. Scott, county agent, spoke on "Community Breeding," and was followed by O. M. Plummer, manager of the Pacific International Live Stock Exposition, who told of the value of the exposition for the live stock breeders. Not the least enjoyable event of the day was the bounteous picnic luncheon, to which each visitor did ample justice.

STEAMERS COLLIDE

NEW YORK, June 27.—The American schooner Friendship, en route to this port from Buenos Aires with a cargo of oil, was rammed and badly damaged 60 miles off New York early today by the Japanese steamer Tauriga Maru.

The Friendship made New York harbor, leaking badly, with her bow-sprit snapped off. A Finnish sailor, who was at the wheel, was carried overboard.

PROSPECTS FOR BIG CHAUTAUQUA VERY BRIGHT

Never before have prospects for the Willamette Valley Chautauqua looked brighter. Every mail brings to the secretary's desk large numbers of inquiries and requests for programs. Tent reservations have so exceeded the expectations that the association has found it necessary to greatly increase its equipment. Vice-president Lew Adams and Secretary Arthur Beattie made a trip to Vancouver and purchased a large number of the popular sized 16x16 army tents to accommodate the campers. These are going fast and more tents will be rented from Portland tent companies.

The program headed by W. J. Bryan, Ida Tarbell, Private Peat, Clemens's Czech-Slovak Band and Castellucci's Concert Band appears to be a rarely strong and interesting affair.

In addition to the entertainment features the local and state organizations are planning some good additional features.

Grange Day, July 16th, The Clackamas County Grange organization will have a big basket dinner at noon and at six o'clock National Grange lecturer John C. Ketchum will be one of the speakers of the day.

Tuesday, July 15th, is University Day. Oregon University and Reed college will be represented by speakers at the Forum hour and Pacific University will have a reunion of students and alumni at a picnic lunch under the great trees in Gladstone Park. Other colleges have been invited and it is hoped all the Oregon higher educational institutions will be represented.

Pennsylvania Day comes July 17th, when former residents of the Quaker state will gather at Chautauqua to honor their fellow citizen, Ida Tarbell.

There will be a "Labor Day" July 12th, when E. J. Stack, of the Federation of Labor, will speak in the morning, and labor people will be invited to plan a big picnic. Other organizations which have prominent places on the program are the W. C. T. U., State Board of Health, State Social Hygiene Society, Federation of Woman's Clubs, Red Cross Nurses, Mother's

BRENTON VEDDER REELECTED

Brenton Vedder was re-elected supervisor of county schools, at the annual meeting of the county educational board held at the courthouse Saturday. His salary of \$1200 remains the same as last year, and a maximum appropriation of \$50 a month was made for traveling expenses. Members of the educational board in attendance were J. E. Calavan, John R. Cole, Adam H. Knight and E. E. Brodie.

COLONEL ROOSEVELT TO BE CANDIDATE OF REPUBLICAN PARTY

MINEOLA, L. I., June 2.—Lieutenant Colonel Theodore Roosevelt of Oyster Bay has agreed to be a candidate for the Republican nomination for assemblyman from the second district of Nassau county. It was announced here today by Edwin J. Conlin, chairman of the Oyster Bay Republican town committee.

This will be Colonel Roosevelt's debut in politics. He recently frowned on efforts of his friends to induce him to run for the Republican nomination for president of the board of aldermen of New York City.

PROMINENT STOCKMAN MURDERED AND ROBBED

Duncan McNichols, a well-known and prominent resident of this county, was shot and instantly killed some time Sunday night or Monday morning at his home on the 82nd street road at the intersection of Sunnyvale street and no clue to the murderer has been found.

McNichols was 40 years of age and had lived here for the past 30 years. He had a small place of eight acres of his own and used a 100-acre tract belonging to his life-long friend, Mr. McBride, of Portland. McNichols was a cattle dealer, buying, raising and selling livestock and was known to carry large amounts of money most of the time. If robbery was the motive for the murder the person or persons who did the deed overlooked \$59 which the coroner found on the man.

Friends say McNichols always carried a wallet, generally containing from \$200 to \$1800 and this was missing when the body was searched.

McNichols was last seen Sunday night about 7 o'clock and evidently after this he took a lantern to the barn and milked, for when the coroner arrived at the place this lantern and a lamp were burning.

Arthur Berner, a neighbor of McNichols, discovered the body Monday morning when he called on the man and immediately notified the sheriff, who went to the scene and later called the coroner.

The body was found just inside the front door and the bullet pierced the forehead just above the right eye, coming out at the rear of the head. A .38-caliber gun was used and death was probably instantaneous, according to Dr. Welsh, who was called by the coroner.

As far as is known the deceased left no relatives in this country. He was a native of Scotland and McBride, who owned part of the place where he resided, was a boyhood friend, they having attended school together.

Joe Keller, of Salem, was on the scene Monday afternoon with his bloodhounds and Sheriff Wilson and Deputy Meads assisted in the search for clues that would lead to the arrest of the murderer.

NEIGHBOR HEARS SHOT ON NIGHT M'NICOL KILLED

Very little was learned of the murder of Duncan McNicol at the coroner's inquest held at the Holman & Pace undertaking parlors Tuesday afternoon and the verdict was that McNicol came to his death by a gunshot wound at the hand of a person or persons unknown.

John Hoffman, a near neighbor, testified that between 11:15 and 11:30 his wife heard a shot and awoke him. Immediately afterward they heard a false automobile start and leaving the place. They thought nothing of the shot as McNicol was in the habit of shooting at all times of the day and night at stray dogs bothering his stock.

The body was discovered Monday morning by Art Berner, who called at the place on business. He noticed the doors were open and looking in saw the body on the floor. He immediately notified Hoffman and they sent in a call for the sheriff, who after being notified was soon at the place.

Monday afternoon Joe Keller, of Salem, arrived with his bloodhounds but as so many people had been there before him it was impossible to pick up the trail of the guilty parties.

McNicol has been in the United States for about 28 years, having been employed at the Ladd farm at Broadmead, Yamhill county, before coming here. He has been caretaker for the farm of D. B. McBride of Portland, and also owned an eight-acre tract adjoining the larger farm. He was 62 years of age and well and favorably known in this county. Neighbors testified that as far as was known he did not have an enemy and the motive for the murder was evidently robbery, as it was a well-known fact that he always carried considerable money with him.

FORMER EMPLOYE OF MURDERED MAN IS SOUGHT BY SHERIFF

Sheriff Wilson and deputies are following a clew which may lead to the capture of the murderer of Duncan McNicol, who was shot and killed some time Sunday night at his home near here. Sheriff Wilson discovered that the dead man had a wide acquaintance with horse traders and stock men of Portland, and a possible motive for the murder lies in the fact that McNicol always carried a large sum of money for buying horses and cattle. An Italian, who was employed some time ago by McNicol, has not been located as yet, and when found, the officials are in the hopes that he can throw some light upon the habits of the murdered man, and his dealing with different persons during the time the Italian was employed on the McNicol farm.

Let the People Decide

We foresee that the people of the United States will be called upon to express themselves in regard to the League of Nations. There are not a few members of the United States senate who will be firm in their refusal to ratify the Treaty of Paris with the Covenant of Mr. Wilson, Mr. Smuts and Lloyd George appended. They continue to insist that the Covenant should not be a part of the Treaty; that they should be divorced, so that the Senate may speedily ratify the Treaty and so that the people may pass upon the Covenant.

The truth is that few of the people of the United States know just what the Covenant is. How many people in Oregon City know, for illustration, just what the Covenant means? They may know the provisions of our new traffic ordinance; they may be familiar with the fish and game laws, and they may even be conversant with the policies of the water board, but as to the Covenant—what is it and what will it do for this country and to this country?

These are questions that only a free and full discussion will answer. The people want to know. They are entitled to know. Right is right and wrong is wrong.

So far as the League of Nations is concerned, it is an American question. It is not and should not be made a partisan question, and, in the language of one man, it is to be solved "without sacrificing our own supreme nationalism, the preservation of which in its integrity is the greatest safeguard for the future." The demand that this Government shall be brought back to the limitations of the constitution in times of peace cannot be ignored, and the people, who are the government, have a right to decide.

AMERICAN ARMY OF OCCUPATION TO LEAVE SOON

WASHINGTON, June 26.—Virtually the entire American army of occupation now in Germany is to be brought home as soon as possible after the conclusion of peace.

Secretary of War Baker has announced that all of the emergency soldiers in the five divisions abroad, as well as those regulars whose enlistments have expired or will expire in the next few months, will be the first to return.

Selling orders for the 4th and 5th divisions, which were countermanded when the further occupation of Germany appeared possible, will be re-issued.

Whether any American soldiers will be left in the allied army of occupation will be determined by the president. War department officials think it likely that 50,000 regulars will be retained from the first three divisions to co-operate with the French and British armies of occupation and the remainder brought home.

Prisoner Caught Making Escape

SALEM, June 27.—Ned McSherry, held in the Marion county jail on a charge of obtaining money under false pretenses, was detected in the act of making his escape about 8 o'clock Thursday night, having cut five of the steel bars separating him from liberty. Three small saws found in McSherry's possession after the discovery of his attempt at escape, are believed to have been smuggled into his cell by friends since his incarceration three weeks ago. McSherry was arrested in Santa Maria, Cal., three weeks ago, charged with a crime committed last September.

State Prison Has Big Service Flag

SALEM, Or., June 30.—Mrs. Joseph Keller, wife of Captain Keller, retiring state parole officer, has designed and made a service flag in honor of the paroled men of the state prison. It contains 50 stars, of which two are gold. Inscribed on the flag are the words: "Paroled men who did their bit in the world war and received full pardon from Governor James Withycombe."

VANCOUVER LICENSE

VANCOUVER, Wash., June 27.—The following were granted a marriage license here today: Clyde Montgomery, 22, and Louva Bell, 17, of Oregon City.

H. C. OF L. GOES DOWN
The high cost of living has taken a drop, affecting every man and woman and many children. The decrease also affects business houses, corporations, banks, county, city and state officials, in fact nearly everybody of high or low degree. On the particular item affected, the decrease amounts to one-third, which is some drop, believe us! And this is it—
The cost of letter postage has been reduced from 3 cents to 2 cents, effective July 1.
Postmaster Cooke says, however, that city letters take the same rate and the old 1 cent rate for drop letters is no more, which means that all letters, even those for delivery in the city limits, require a 2 cent stamp.

SCHUEBEL SAYS USE HIS BILL IN STRIKE

Representative Schuebel, of the 1919 legislature, has been elected Governor Olcott, Mayor of Portland, Commissioners Woodward, and Flynn, of the council, and urging them to make use of the strike of the telephone employees and the electrical workers.

"Chapter 178, page 252, general laws of Oregon for 1919, provides a remedy for all such cases," says Mr. Schuebel, "and authorizes the city officials to make an investigation and find out what the difficulty is and who is responsible. This law was passed for all such cases. As the author of the bill I am very much interested in seeing it put into effect, because I believe the public is entitled to protection, and is just as much interested and possibly more so, than the individuals involved. This is the time to test the bill. The public should not be inconvenienced or annoyed without knowing the reason for it. It is up to the commission to take action, and if they refuse to act, the Governor might suggest what their duty is, and that other men could be appointed who would act. This law should not be a dead letter. There is no reason why a law that is placed on the statute books for the purpose of determining the responsibility for strikes, should not be utilized. If employees are not properly treated, and not paid a living wage, the public should be given the facts by an impartial tribunal. I hope the board will take necessary steps to bring about a proper investigation."

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INSANE MAN ATTACKS FAMILY AND KILLS SON

PORTLAND, July 1.—R. W. Stafford, Jr., ex-captain in the Minnesota state guard, and son of a pioneer business man of Barnum, Minn., killed his 1-year-old son, Walter, and probably fatally injured his wife and a 5-year-old son, Wirt Stafford, by attacking them with a hatchet about 3 P. M. today, and then committed suicide by cutting his own throat after setting fire to the family home at 1358 Front street.

The family came to Portland from Matow, Minn., three months ago, at the request of Ralph Hahn, vice-president and general manager of the Sterling Food Products company, who had hired Mr. Stafford as superintendent of the company's plant in South Portland.

The authorities say temporary insanity is the only explanation of the tragedy, inasmuch as all persons interviewed by police say Mr. Stafford had not quarreled with his family. He suddenly left his work shortly before 3 o'clock, walked to his home, which was close by, and apparently attempted to murder his whole family. Three children escaped.

SHORT TERM NOTES

WASHINGTON, June 25.—Two new series of short term 4 1/2 per cent certificates of indebtedness were announced today by the treasury department to be dated July 1. One issue will mature September 15 and the other December 15, dates on which income and excess profit taxes are due. The certificates will be tax exempt except for state or inheritance taxes and income surtaxes. The announcement said a limited amount would be issued.

MOBS RIOT IN ITALY AND SEIZE SUPPLIES

FORTI, Italy, July 2.—After a great meeting here yesterday, in which a vast crowd protested against the high cost of living, the people, excited by inflammatory speeches, attacked, sacked and destroyed many shops which refused to sell commodities at lower prices.

The fury of the mob made no distinction and had no limits. All the principal shops were plundered and the mobs controlled the entire city. They took possession of lorries and transported all kinds of goods and food supplies from the pillaged shops to the chamber of labor.

On the walls of this chamber they wrote: "These goods are at the disposal of the people."

The situation grew worse during the day, assuming a revolutionary character and the mob continued to loot and destroy all kinds of property.

The food riots here, however, differ fundamentally from those at Spezia early in June. At Spezia the rioters looted for their own advantage while at Forti most of what was taken from the shops was transferred to the care of the municipality or the chamber of labor to be distributed to the people or sold at low prices.

The value of the goods stored by the municipality was estimated at 3,000,000 lire.

TROLMAN KILLS ROBBER IN BATTLE ON PORTLAND STREETS

PORTLAND, June 30.—Standing, a perfect target, under an arc light, Patrolman W. A. Finn last night battled with three dangerous burglars hidden behind an automobile, killing John Latti and wounding Richard Berg. Dave Miller, third member of the gang, escaped, but was arrested later.

The three men are all former convicts and, according to the police, are responsible for many recent hold-ups and burglaries. They were closely connected with a gang composed of Frank Weger, Louis Tebeau and Harold Coffman, who were found this morning in possession of four sticks of dynamite, with fuses and caps, by Motorcycle Patrolmen Kelly and Rippen. All six men are former convicts from the Oregon state penitentiary and have all been at liberty but a short time. The police believe that they have planned the crimes before they left the prison.

Latti, Berg and Miller broke into the garage and accessory shop of T. J. North, at Williams avenue and Broadway, near midnight last night. They were discovered by George Miller, of the Broadway Auto service, as they were going out in a stolen machine loaded with tires. Miller summoned Patrolman Finn, the officer on the beat. Together, in Miller's machine, they pursued the fleeing burglars until the latter stopped, due to engine trouble, at Williams avenue and Going street. The speed of Miller's machine carried it past the robbers' car, but Patrolman Finn jumped out and started running back. The machine was under some trees and could not be seen by the policeman, but as he came into the light of the arc light one of the burglars opened fire on him.

CROWDED CONDITION CAUSES REMOVAL OF FEDERAL PRISONERS

WASHINGTON, July 2.—Partly to relieve overcrowded conditions and partly to provide a more suitable place of confinement for certain men, who had found it impossible to adapt themselves to the discipline and objects of the disciplinary barracks at Fort Leavenworth, instructions have been issued today by the secretary of war for the transfer of between 60 and 70 prisoners to the United States disciplinary barracks at Alcatraz Island, San Francisco bay, and the war prison barracks at Fort Douglas, Utah.

A number of conscientious objectors confined at Leavenworth because of inability to "adapt themselves" have solved the problem by taking French leave according to recent press reports, with disastrous results to morale and discipline among the other prisoners.